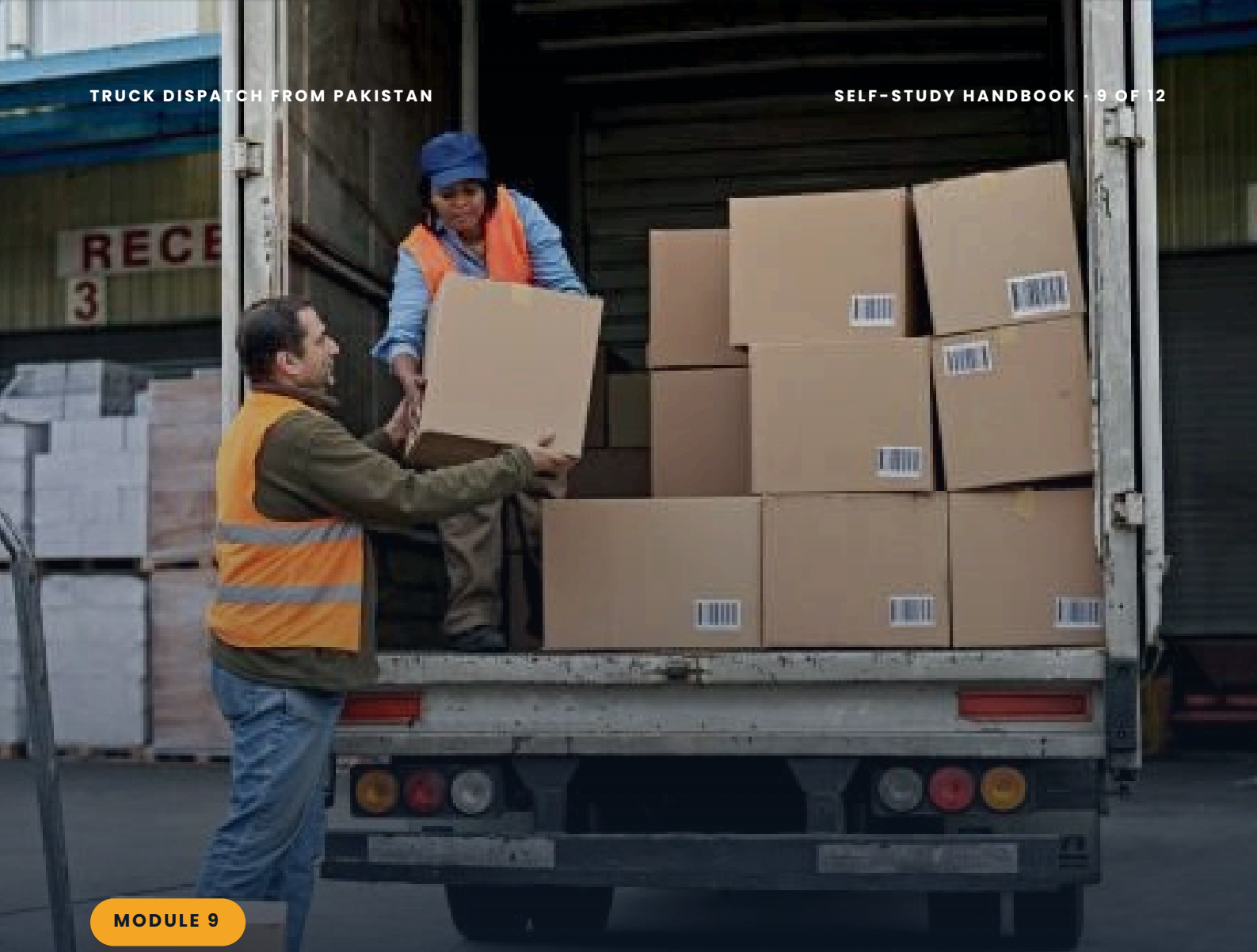




MODULE 9

Booking, Load Execution & Paperwork

From “book it” to “paid”:
every step, every document.

Reading and fixing rate confirmations, the driver’s dispatch sheet, a full Load 2 timeline in U.S. and Pakistan time, pickup steps, BOL rules and SLC, check calls and tracking, real BOL-to-POD documents, invoices, payment paths and file-keeping.

8

steps in a load’s life

3real documents, one
load**6**errors to find on a
rate con**~6 hours**

study + practice

How to use this module

In Module 8 you negotiated Load 2 to **\$1,750** and Mike approved it. Now the real work starts: a rate con to check, a driver to brief, a pickup, 715 miles, a delivery and an invoice. This module follows that load, hour by hour.

Load 2 (practice)

PF-20931 · Peachtree Freight → Blue Line Transport

Bolingbrook, IL → Atlanta, GA · 715 mi + 12 deadhead · paper products, 22 pallets, **38,500 lb** · pickup **Wed 14 Oct, 9–11 AM CT** · delivery **Thu 15 Oct, 1 PM ET** · **\$1,750 all-in** · detention after 2 h at \$50/h · lumpers paid by broker · tracking required · driver Carlos, Truck 12.

Study rhythm (about 6 hours)

- **Session 1 (1.5 h):** load lifecycle, rate con clauses, rate con checklist.
- **Session 2 (1.5 h):** dispatch sheet, timeline, pickup, check calls.
- **Session 3 (1.5 h):** POD, document chain, invoice, payment, files.
- **Session 4 (1.5 h):** practice and drill 11.

Contents

L9.1 From booking to a signed rate con	4
L9.2 Dispatching the driver	7
L9.3 Pickup and transit	9
L9.4 Delivery, paperwork and getting paid	11
Practice: rate con, BOL, POD, messages	17
Answer key · Glossary · Sources	20



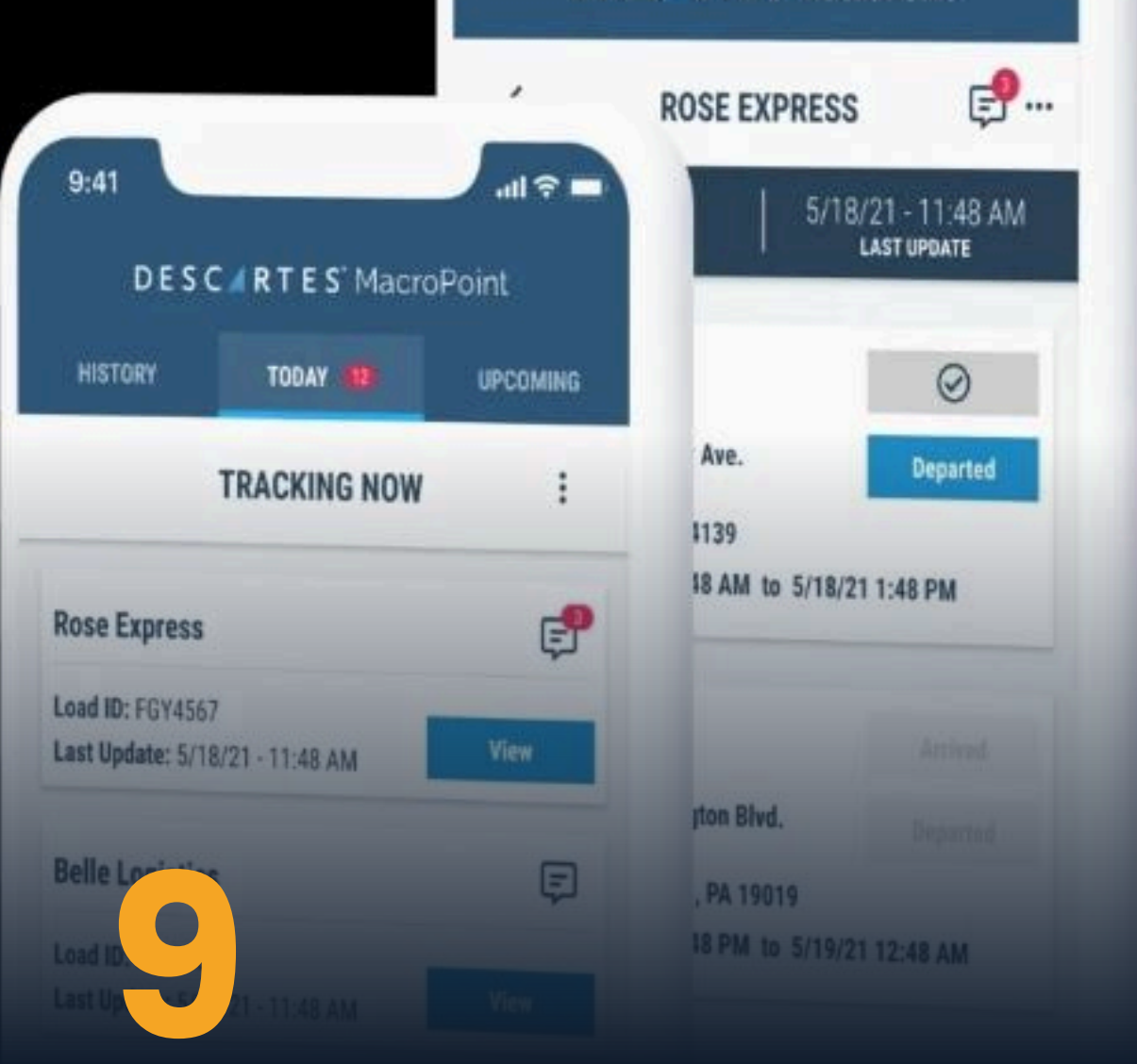
Real documents inside

Your OMNITECH manual contains a rare full set for one load (#12354): the rate con, the bill of lading and the signed proof of delivery. You'll read all three.



Your role

You coordinate and document. The driver handles freight and signs at the dock; the carrier signs contracts and owns the money.



MODULE 9 · EXECUTION

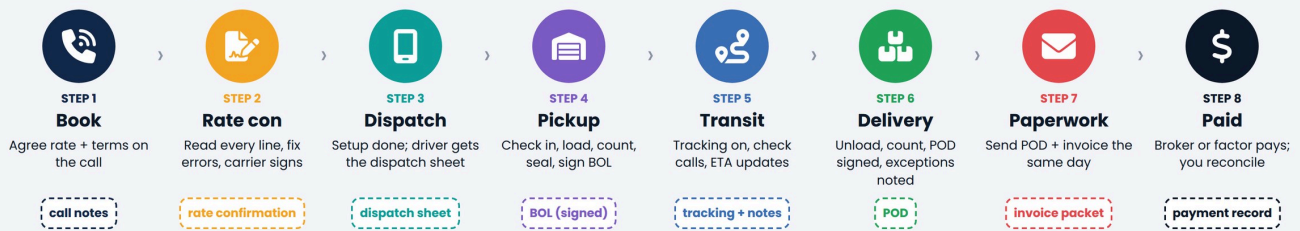
Booking is the easy part. Delivering the paperwork is the job.

The background shows a real tracking app (Descartes MacroPoint) of the kind brokers require. Brokers judge carriers on communication as much as on-time delivery: fast updates, clean paperwork and no surprises win repeat loads.

The life of a load

The life of a load: eight steps, eight documents

From “book it” to money in the bank. You coordinate every step from Pakistan.



Every step leaves a document. If it isn't written down, it didn't happen: detention, damage, a changed appointment, a late POD.

Your job is the thread. The driver drives, the broker sells, the carrier owns. You keep every step moving and every document matching.

Money is at the end. A load isn't done when it delivers; it's done when it's paid and filed.

Who does what

Person	Main jobs on this load
You	Check rate con, brief driver, track, update broker, collect and send documents
Driver	Pickup, count, seal, drive legally, deliver, get signatures, send photos
Carrier (Mike)	Signs the rate con (or authorizes you), chooses payment path, owns disputes
Broker	Sends rate con and tracking, handles shipper and receiver, pays



Write it down

Every call, message and change goes into the load notes with the time and time zone. If there's a dispute in six weeks, your notes are the carrier's evidence.



One load at a time, then many

Real dispatchers run several trucks at once. The steps are the same; a simple tracker (page 16) keeps each load's next action visible.

The clauses that cost money

Reading a real rate con: the clauses that cost money

Load #12354 from your OMNITECH manual. Markers added for this course.

Ship Express, LLC
 211 Walnut St
 Lebanon, OH 45036
 Carrier: SHOLAY QUALITY AFRICAN MARKET INC
 Contact: Phone: 973-517-6393
 Fax: MC # MC1488753
 DCF # 3947671

LOAD CONFIRMATION AND PAYMENT AGREEMENT - PLEASE SIGN & RETURN ASAP

DATE: 02/20/2023
 TIME: 7am-8am
 PICKUP #:

DATE: Mon, 02/20/2023
 TIME: 12:00 PM
 DELIVERY #:

PRODUCT: Skidded Paper
 PO #: 215
 WEIGHT: 2,000 lbs
 QUANTITY: 10
 TYPE: BCL #:

NOTE: "Driver MUST accept Monrovia tracking. If driver fails to accept tracking or disables tracking during course of load, \$150 will be deducted from rate."

***** Please email all invoices & bills of lading to: AM@shipexpressdelivery.com *****

BROKER SIGNATURE: John Brubaker, Ship Express, LLC
 jbrubaker@shipexpressdelivery.com
 www.shipexpressdelivery.com
 02/18/2023 02:44 PM

CARRIER SIGNATURE: Tasha Price
 Please email 888-271-8888
 215 Express, LLC
 215 Express, LLC
 Lebanon, OH 45036

- 1 "Confirmation must be signed and returned before driver can be dispatched." No signed rate con, no load.
- 2 Tracking required: \$150 deduction if the driver refuses or disables it.
- 3 POD within 72 hours by email or fax, or \$150 deduction.
- 4 Carrier responsible for shortages, damages and late delivery fees. Broker "not liable to pay Truck Order Not Used" (no TONU).
- 5 Invoices and BOLs go to the AP email on the rate con, not to your sales contact.
- 6 Carrier signature: only someone the carrier authorizes signs (Module 5 dispatch agreement).

Read it like a contract, because it is one. The terms bind the carrier once signed. Clauses 2-4 are where money is lost.

If a term is unacceptable, ask before signing: "Can you add TONU of \$150 if the load cancels on arrival?" Changes must appear on a corrected rate con.



Correction: "The rate con is just a receipt for the rate"

It is the contract for this load. It usually refers to the broker-carrier agreement signed at setup, and together they set the rules: payment, fines, liability and accessories.



Right to see the record

FMCSA requires brokers to keep a record of each brokered transaction for three years, and **each party to the transaction has the right to review it** (49 CFR 371.3).

Common rate con clauses and how to respond

Clause	What it means	Your move
Tracking required	Deduction if tracking is refused or stops	Set up tracking before pickup; tell the driver
POD deadline	Fine if the POD arrives late (e.g. 72 h)	Send the POD the same day
Late delivery fine	Money off if late, sometimes a fixed amount	Ask for a grace period, or removal when the delay isn't the carrier's fault
Detention terms	Free time, hourly rate, cap, notice required	Know the notice rule (e.g. call when 2 h reached) and log in/out times
TONU	Pay if the load cancels on arrival, or "not liable"	Ask for TONU on loads with long deadhead
No re-brokering	Carrier must haul the load itself	Always true for you (Module 8)
Cargo liability	Carrier responsible for loss, damage, shortage	Check the carrier's cargo insurance limits cover the freight value

Check every rate con against the call

#	Check	Against
1	Broker	Name, MC, address, contact = your vetting (Module 8)
2	Carrier	Legal name, MC, USDOT exactly right
3	Equipment	The truck you offered (dry van, 53', no air-ride)
4	Stops	Addresses, dates, times, time zones, FCFS/appointment, reference numbers
5	Freight	Commodity, pieces, weight, temperature if any
6	Money	Rate, all-in or linehaul + FSC, total
7	Accessorials	Detention, lumper, TONU, extra stops as agreed
8	Rules	Tracking, fines, deductions, POD deadline
9	Payment	Terms, quick pay, where to send invoices

The practice rate con for Load 2, with six deliberate errors, is on page 17.



When something is wrong

"Hi, this is Jawad with Blue Line, about load PF-20931. The rate con shows \$1,650 and a reefer. We agreed \$1,750 for a dry van. Could you send a corrected rate con, please?"



Fix it before anyone signs

Never sign "and fix it later". Once signed, the wrong rate or missing detention is what the carrier agreed to. Ask for a corrected version; check it again.



After signing

Save the signed copy in the load folder (page 15), send the setup documents if requested, and only then send the dispatch sheet to the driver.

Briefing the driver

The dispatch sheet: everything the driver needs, nothing extra

Load 2 as Carlos sees it on his phone. Facility names are fictional.

Dispatch • Truck 12 • Carlos

LOAD PF-20931 • Peachtree Freight

Broker contact	Office line on rate con
Tracking	MacroPoint link by text – accept it

PICKUP • Wed 14 Oct • 9–11 AM CT

Shipper	Practice Paper Co.
Address	Bolingbrook, IL
PU #	55812
Load	22 pallets • 38,500 lb • paper
Notes	Seal # on BOL • photo BOL

DELIVERY • Thu 15 Oct • 1:00 PM ET

Receiver	Practice DC
Address	Atlanta, GA
DEL #	A-7730
Notes	Lumper paid by broker • get receipt

What the driver needs: load and reference numbers, exact addresses and hours, appointment times **with time zones**, commodity, pieces, weight, special instructions, tracking, who to call.

What the driver may not need: the rate. Some carriers share it, some don't. Ask Mike once and follow his rule.

Send it in writing (text or app), then call to confirm. Ask the driver to read back the appointment time and PU number (drill 3 from Module 1).

Addresses: check the facility's truck entrance and parking on the map before sending. A wrong gate costs an hour.



Confirm by phone

"Carlos, you're set for PF-20931: Bolingbrook, pickup number 5-5-8-1-2, window 9 to 11 Central tomorrow. Delivery Atlanta Thursday 1 PM Eastern. Can you read back the pickup number and the appointment?"

Before the driver rolls

- Signed rate con saved; setup complete with the broker.
- Dispatch sheet sent and read back by the driver.
- Tracking link sent and accepted (or ELD tracking connected).
- Hours checked: the plan fits the driver's clocks (Module 4).
- Route checked: truck entrance, parking, any low bridges or restricted roads.
- Broker has the driver's name, truck and trailer numbers, and cell if required.



If the driver says the plan won't work

Listen. The driver sees hours, weather and fatigue you don't. Adjust the plan, tell the broker early, and never push him to drive over his hours (Module 4, coercion is prohibited).



Driver information sharing

Brokers often ask for the driver's name and number for tracking and check calls. Share only what the carrier approves, through the broker's official channel.

Load 2, hour by hour

Load 2 from booking to POD

Practice timeline in U.S. time (left) and your Pakistan time (right, PKT = CT + 10 h, ET + 9 h in U.S. summer time).

Wed 7:55 AM CT	Rate con signed; dispatch sheet sent	PKT 5:55 PM
8:35 AM CT	Carlos checks in at the shipper	PKT 6:35 PM
10:35 AM CT	Loaded: BOL photo, seal #, SLC noted	PKT 8:35 PM
10:45 AM CT	Broker update: loaded, ETA Thu 12:00 ET	PKT 8:45 PM
2:40 PM CT	30-minute break; check call	PKT 12:40 AM Thu
9:30 PM CT	10-hour break near Manchester, TN (~520 mi)	PKT 7:30 AM Thu
Thu 8:30 AM ET	Carlos starts driving (~190 mi left)	PKT 5:30 PM
12:00 PM ET	At receiver, checked in; appointment 1 PM	PKT 9:00 PM
2:10 PM ET	Empty. POD photo: clean, 22 pallets	PKT 11:10 PM
2:40 PM ET	POD + invoice sent; broker told "delivered"	PKT 11:40 PM

HOS check (Module 4): Carlos starts duty at 7:30 AM CT. His 14-hour window ends 9:30 PM CT; he drives about 10.3 hours with a 30-minute break, takes 10 hours off, and has plenty of time for the 1 PM ET appointment.

Time zones: the pickup is Central, the delivery is Eastern, and your notes are in Pakistan time. Write the zone after every time, every time.

Shift handover: the 10-hour break falls in your morning. Leave a note for the day team or the carrier: load status, next ETA, open issues.

Your time vs their time

U.S. zone	Pakistan time (PKT = UTC+5)
Eastern (EDT, UTC-4)	+9 hours · 1 PM ET = 10 PM PKT
Central (CDT, UTC-5)	+10 hours · 9 AM CT = 7 PM PKT
After U.S. clocks go back (EST/CST, early Nov)	add 1 more hour: +10 / +11



The most common dispatch mistake

Mixing time zones: telling a driver "1 PM" when the appointment is Eastern and he's still in Central time. Always say the zone out loud: **"1 PM Eastern."**

Hours-of-service math for Load 2 (Module 4)

Item	Wednesday	Thursday
Start of duty	7:30 AM CT	7:30 AM CT (8:30 ET) after 10 h off
14-hour window ends	9:30 PM CT	9:30 PM CT
On-duty not driving	Check-in and loading ~2 h	Check-in and unloading ~2 h
Driving	~10.3 h (limit 11) · ~520 mi	~3.5 h · ~190 mi
30-minute break	After 8 h of driving	Not needed before delivery
Hours used on the 70	About 20 of Carlos's 40 remaining hours (~13.5 on Wednesday, ~6 on Thursday)	

At the shipper

At the shipper: eight steps before the truck leaves

What you coach the driver to do, and what you check from the BOL photo.

STEP 1 Arrive early Check in with PU #, load #, carrier name	STEP 2 Get a door Note arrival time (detention clock)	STEP 3 Watch or wait Live load; driver checks load is secure if allowed	STEP 4 Count Count pallets/pieces if possible	STEP 5 Read the BOL Shipper, consignee, pieces, weight, commodity, your carrier name	STEP 6 Seal Seal number on the BOL; photo of the seal	STEP 7 Notations SLC if the driver couldn't count or see; any damage	STEP 8 Sign + photo Out time on BOL; photo to dispatch before leaving
--	---	---	---	--	---	--	---

SLC = shipper load and count. If the driver couldn't see or count the freight (sealed trailer, or not allowed on the dock), "SLC" on the BOL shifts the burden: the shipper must prove the carrier caused a shortage or damage. It doesn't protect against damage the driver could see.

BOL must show (49 CFR 373.101): consignor and consignee names, origin and destination, number of packages, description, and weight or volume when it affects the rate.

Mismatch? The driver doesn't leave. You call the broker (Module 8, page 11) and get the change in writing.

Live load vs drop and hook

Type	What happens	Watch for
Live load	Driver waits while the shipper loads	In/out times for detention
Drop and hook	Driver drops an empty trailer, takes a pre-loaded one	Seal, SLC, trailer number, condition
Preloaded	Trailer loaded before arrival	SLC, seal photo, weight



The law behind SLC

When the bill of lading shows the shipper loaded the goods, federal law (49 U.S.C. 80113) limits the carrier's liability for damage caused by improper loading. The driver still must refuse a load that is visibly unsafe.



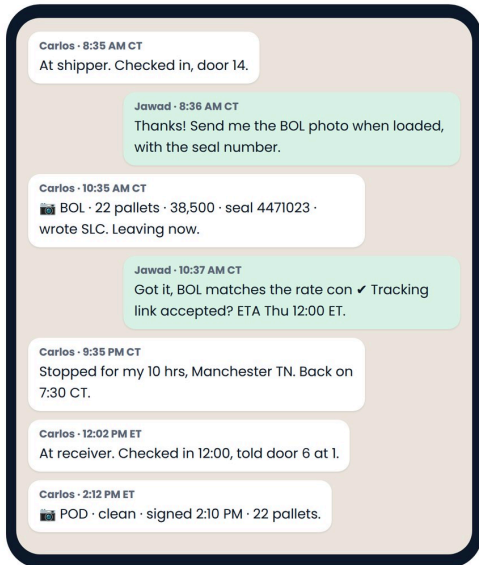
Overweight or unsafe load?

If the load looks overweight, poorly secured or not as described, the driver doesn't leave. Scale it if needed (Module 2) and call the broker. Safety comes before the appointment.

Check calls and tracking

Check calls: short, timed, written

Practice messages for Load 2. Driver on the left, you on the right; broker updates beside.



Updates you send the broker

To broker - 10:45 AM CT
PF-20931 loaded 10:35 CT. 22 plts, 38,500 lb, seal 4471023. Tracking active. ETA Thu 15 Oct 12:00 ET.

To broker - Thu 12:05 PM ET
PF-20931 on site at receiver 12:00 ET for 1 PM appt.

To broker - Thu 2:40 PM ET
PF-20931 delivered 2:10 PM ET, clean. Signed POD and invoice attached.

When to call the broker, not just email: late for an appointment, breakdown, refused or damaged freight, anything that changes the plan. Call first, then confirm in writing.

Keep it short: load #, status, time with zone, facts (pieces, seal), next ETA.

Tracking apps

Brokers track loads with tools such as **Descartes**, **MacroPoint** or **Trucker Tools**. MacroPoint can pull location from the carrier's **ELD** (preferred: no app needed), from a TMS, or from a driver phone app. It says it tracks only during the load session.

The rate con for #12354 deducted **\$150** if the driver refused or disabled tracking. Make sure it is running before the truck leaves.



Check-call rhythm

At dispatch · at shipper · loaded (BOL photo) · every 3–4 hours or at breaks · any delay, immediately · at receiver · empty (POD photo).



Pakistan tip

Use one group chat per truck with the carrier included, plus a pinned message with the current load. Everyone sees the same information, and nothing depends on your shift.

The proof of delivery

Reading a real proof of delivery

Load #12354: the Green Bay Packaging BOL after delivery to Tracco. Real document from your OMNITECH manual; markers added.

Green Bay Packaging Inc.
 Cincinnati Division
 760 Kingsview Drive
 Lebanon, Ohio 45036
 513-489-8700

SHIP TO:
 Tracco LLC
 1661 East 11st Street
 Owensboro KY 42303

SOLD TO:
 66589
 TRACCO LLC
 Div of Tasty Brands LLC
 6805 Jericho Tpke Ste 101W
 Syosset NY 11791

Delivery Docket
SHORT BILL OF LADING
NON-NEGOTIABLE

BOL#: 22722019
 BOL Date: 2/20/2023 7:55:28 AM
 Date Recd: _____
 Page: 1 of 1

RECEIVED BY: _____
DATE: _____
TIME: _____
COMMENTS: _____
PALETTES IN: _____
PALETTES OUT: _____
CARRIER: BOX
TRAILER: _____

Customer PO	Job Number	Description	Units	Unit Summary	Qty	Weight	Area
P452	30171	Uncoated Heavy Paper (143000) D REG - VPA ECT 44 C FLUTE	2	1 177	121	112	5,100
P452	30172	Rollsaw Uncoated Chalken Board 143000 D REG - VPA ECT 44 C FLUTE	8	1 401	3,071	4,440	20,204
						Total Area (sq)	31,204
						Total Pallet Weight (lbs)	5,100
						Total Weight (lbs)	5,100
						Total Weight (lbs)	5,100

Driver/Carrier Signature: _____ **Date/Time:** _____ **Total # Units:** 10

TPKY OR TRACCO
 Date Recd: 2-20-23
 Qty Recd: 10
 Over: _____ Short: _____ Dmgd: _____
 Recd by: _____

- 1 Same BOL# 22722019: the BOL becomes the POD when the receiver signs it.
- 2 Total units 10 on the BOL...
- 3 ...Qty received 10 on the receiver's stamp. Counts match.
- 4 Over / Short / Damaged all blank = a clean delivery.
- 5 Received by: signature and date (2-20-23). A printed name and time would be better.
- 6 Driver/customer signature and pickup date/time left blank. Coach drivers to fill these in.

A clean POD gets paid. Missing signatures, unreadable photos or unexplained notes delay payment or lead to deductions.

Exceptions: if anything is short or damaged, the receiver writes it on the POD ("2 pallets damaged") and the driver photographs it. Tell the broker before the driver leaves (Module 10 covers claims).

Clean vs exception POD

POD shows	What you do
Clean	Photo/scan, send with invoice today
Short	Driver photographs the count and trailer; call broker before leaving
Damaged	Photos of damage and packaging; exact note on POD
Refused	Don't leave or dump freight; broker gives written instructions



Ask the driver for the right photo

"Carlos, please send the full signed page, flat, in good light, so I can read the stamp, the count and the name."



Records to keep

Bills of lading and delivery records: at least 1 year under FMCSA's record rules (49 CFR 379, Appendix A).

Three documents, one story

One load, one paper trail

Load #12354 from your OMNITECH manual: three real documents, plus the invoice they produce.

1 • Rate confirmation

The deal: \$700, 240 mi, 7–8 AM pickup, noon delivery, the rules.

2 • Bill of lading

The shipment: what left Green Bay Packaging, 10 units, 5,729 lb.

3 • Proof of delivery

The proof: Tracco received 10, nothing short or damaged.

4 • Invoice

Illustrative invoice built from the three real documents. Sent to the AP email within 72 h.

They must tell one story. Same load #, same BOL #, same pieces, same addresses, and a rate that matches the invoice. Every mismatch is a question the broker's AP team will ask before paying.

Keep them together as one PDF packet per load, named the same way every time (page 15).

Spot the mismatch

Compare #12354's rate con and BOL: rate con weight **2,000 lb**, BOL weight **5,729 lb** (Module 8, page 11). The POD shows 10 units received, matching the BOL. A broker AP team may ask about the weight difference before paying. That's why you resolve mismatches at pickup, in writing.



What a BOL must include

Under 49 CFR 373.101: consignor and consignee names; origin and destination; number of packages; description of the freight; weight, volume or measurement when used for rating.

What each document proves

Document	Proves	Issued by	Carrier keeps
Rate con	The price and rules agreed	Broker	Signed copy
BOL	What was handed to the carrier, and in what condition	Shipper	Driver's copy + photo
POD	What the receiver accepted, and any exceptions	Receiver signs the BOL/receipt	Signed copy
Receipts	Costs paid on the broker's behalf (lumper, scale)	Facility / vendor	Original + scan
Invoice	What the carrier asks to be paid	Carrier (you prepare)	Copy + sent email

The invoice

The invoice: short, exact, attached

Practice invoice for Load 2. Blue Line and Peachtree are fictional.

BLUE LINE TRANSPORT LLC

MC 1298456 · USDOT 3847291 · practice carrier

INVOICE

No. BL-1024

Date: 15 Oct 2026

Bill to

Peachtree Freight (practice)

Accounts payable (email on rate con)

Remit to

Blue Line Transport LLC

or the factor named on the NOA

Load PF-20931 · BOL 7719-04 · Bolingbrook, IL → Atlanta, GA

Picked up 14 Oct 2026 · Delivered 15 Oct 2026 2:10 PM ET

Description	Amount
Line haul, all-in (per rate con)	\$1,750.00
Detention (none: 70 min on site)	\$0.00
Lumper (paid by broker directly)	\$0.00
TOTAL DUE	\$1,750.00

Terms per rate confirmation: net 30. Attached: signed rate con, signed BOL/POD.

An invoice must match the rate con. Load #, amounts and accessorial exactly as agreed. Add detention or lumper only with proof: in/out times, receipt, broker approval.

Numbering: one sequence per carrier (BL-1023, BL-1024...). Never reuse a number.

Send it the day the truck empties. Invoice + POD to the AP address or factor, in one email with the load # in the subject: "Invoice BL-1024 · Load PF-20931 · POD attached".

Invoice packet checklist

- Invoice with its own number, load #, BOL #, dates, amounts
- Signed rate con (or corrected version)
- Signed BOL/POD, readable
- Receipts for any reimbursed costs (lumper, scale)
- Detention proof: in/out times and broker approval (Module 10)



Deadlines are money

Some rate cons set a POD deadline (72 hours on #12354) and fine or deduct after it. Send the packet the same day the truck empties.



One email, one load

Subject: "Invoice BL-1024 · Load PF-20931 · POD attached". Attach PDFs, not links. Save the sent email in the load folder.

Why invoices get held, and the fix

Reason	Fix
POD unreadable or missing a page	Ask the driver to rescan flat, full page; send PDF
Amount doesn't match the rate con	Invoice only what's on the (corrected) rate con, plus approved extras
Wrong load or reference number	Copy the broker's load # exactly from the rate con
Sent to the wrong address	Use the AP email on the rate con, or the factor if factored
Detention added without proof or approval	Attach in/out times and the broker's written approval (Module 10)

Getting paid

Getting paid: three paths

Same invoice packet, different speed and cost. The carrier chooses the path; you send the right documents to the right place.

Standard terms	You send: Invoice + POD to broker AP	What happens: Broker pays in its terms, e.g. net 30	Speed ~30+ days	Carrier receives 100% of the rate
Broker quick pay	You send: Invoice + POD, request quick pay	What happens: Broker pays fast for a fee	Speed ~1–5 days	Carrier receives rate - quick-pay fee (e.g. 2%)
Factoring	You send: Invoice + POD to the factor (NOA on file)	What happens: Factor advances, then collects from broker	Speed ~1–2 days	Carrier receives rate - factoring fee (e.g. 3%)

Load 2 example: \$1,750 · quick pay at 2% = \$1,715 in about two days · factoring at 3% = \$1,697.50 · standard terms = \$1,750 in about 30 days. Terms are practice values; read each rate con.

If the carrier factors, the invoice must go to the factor, and the broker must pay the factor (Module 5 NOA). Sending it to the broker instead causes double-payment problems.

Track every invoice: sent date, due date, paid date, amount. Chase politely on the due date (Module 8 escalation ladder).

Invoice tracker (one row per load)

Invoice	Load	Broker	Amount	Sent	Path	Due	Paid	Notes
BL-1024	PF-20931	Peachtree	\$1,750.00	15 Oct	Standard	14 Nov		POD clean
BL-1025	—							

Practice rows. The carrier (or its bookkeeper) owns the accounts; you keep the tracker current so nothing is forgotten.

Following up on payment

When	Action
Day 0	Invoice packet sent; confirm receipt
Day 25	Polite check: "Is BL-1024 scheduled for payment?"
Day 31	Follow-up with invoice attached again
Day 45+	Tell Mike; escalation ladder (Module 8)



The polite check

"Hi, this is Jawad with Blue Line Transport. I'm checking on invoice BL-1024 for load PF-20931, sent October 15. Could you confirm the payment date? Thank you."

Keeping the records

One folder per load

A simple naming system for the carrier's shared drive. Practice names.

```

Blue Line Transport
├── 2026-10 October
│   └── 2026-10-14_PF-20931_Bolingbrook-Atlanta
│       ├── 01_RateCon_signed.pdf
│       ├── 02_DispatchSheet.pdf
│       ├── 03_BOL_pickup.jpg
│       ├── 04_POD_signed.pdf
│       ├── 05_Lumper_receipt.jpg (if any)
│       ├── 06_Invoice_BL-1024.pdf
│       ├── 07_Notes_checkcalls.txt
│       └── 08_Payment_confirmation.pdf
├── Carrier documents (MC, COI, W-9, NOA)
└── Broker list & setups
  
```

Name = date + load # + lane. Sorting by name sorts by date. Anyone can find any load in ten seconds.

Retention: FMCSA's record rules (49 CFR 379) set **1 year** for bills of lading, freight bills and delivery records. Brokers keep transaction records for 3 years (49 CFR 371.3), and each party may review the broker's record of the transaction. Carriers often keep longer for tax and claims: ask the carrier.

Whose files? They belong to the carrier. Use the carrier's shared drive or TMS, not your personal phone gallery.

Scan quality: flat, full page, readable signature and stamp. Use a phone scanner app and send PDF, not blurry photos.

Close-out checklist (after payment)

1. Payment amount matches the invoice (or the deduction is explained).
2. Payment confirmation saved in the load folder.
3. Invoice tracker marked paid.
4. Broker notes updated: pay speed, service, issues.
5. Load economics card updated with the real result (Module 7).



Privacy

Carrier documents contain bank details, tax IDs and driver information. Keep them in the carrier's system only, with a strong password and MFA. Never forward them from personal accounts.

Photo and scan standards for drivers

Good	Bad
Whole page, flat, all four corners visible	Cut-off edges, folded page, finger over text
Daylight or cab light, no shadow	Dark cab, flash glare on the stamp
Scanner app → one PDF, all pages	Five separate blurry photos
Signature, stamp and count readable	"It was signed, trust me"

The load tracker and drill 11

Truck	Load	Status	Next event (with zone)	Next action	Docs	Invoice
12	PF-20931	In transit	Deliver Thu 1:00 PM ET	Check call at 10-h break end	RC ✓ BOL ✓	—
7	LL-448210	Booked	Pickup Thu 8:00 AM CT	Send dispatch sheet	RC ✓	—
3	HP-55190	Delivered	—	POD blurry: ask driver to rescan	RC ✓ BOL ✓ POD ✗	Hold

Practice rows for a three-truck carrier. One glance shows what to do next for every truck.



Say it out loud • drill 11: the loaded update call

“Hi, this is Jawad with Blue Line Transport, MC 1298456, updating load PF-20931. We’re loaded as of 10:35 Central: 22 pallets, 38,500 pounds, seal number 4-4-7-1-0-2-3. Tracking is active. ETA Thursday noon Eastern for the 1 PM appointment. I’ll send the BOL now.”



And the delivery update

“Load PF-20931 delivered at 2:10 Eastern, clean, 22 pallets, signed by M. Lopez. POD and invoice BL-1024 are in your AP inbox. Thank you, and if you have anything else out of Atlanta or back to Chicago, we’d like to hear about it.”



Always ask for the next load

The delivery call is the best moment to ask for repeat freight: the broker just saw you perform.

End-of-shift handover note (template)

HANDOVER • Blue Line • Thu 15 Oct • 4:00 AM PKT (Wed 6:00 PM CT)
 TRUCK 12 • PF-20931 • in transit • stopping ~9:30 PM CT near Manchester TN • next: resume 7:30 AM CT, deliver Thu 1 PM ET • tracking OK
 TRUCK 7 • LL-448210 • booked • PU Thu 8 AM CT • dispatch sheet sent, driver confirmed
 TRUCK 3 • HP-55190 • delivered • POD rescan requested • invoice on hold
 OPEN ISSUES: none urgent • Mike informed of all three

Exercise 1 • Check the rate con

Practice: check this rate con against your call notes

Load 2 (Bolingbrook → Atlanta). A fictional rate con with deliberate mistakes.

PEACHTREE FREIGHT		RATE CONFIRMATION	
Practice broker - fictional		Load # PF-20931	
Carrier	Blue Line Transport LLC • MC 1298465 • USDOT 3847291		
Equipment	53' Reefer		
Pickup	Bolingbrook, IL • Wed 14 Oct 2026 • 09:00–11:00 CT • PU# 55812		
Delivery	Atlanta, GA • Wed 14 Oct 2026 • 13:00 ET (appointment) • DEL# A-7730		
Commodity	Paper products • 22 pallets • 38,500 lb		
Rate	Linehaul all-in: \$1,650.00 • Total: \$1,650.00		
Accessorials	No detention paid. Carrier responsible for lumper fees.		
Tracking	MacroPoint required from pickup to delivery.		
Payment	Net 30 from receipt of invoice + signed POD. Quick pay 2% (2 business days).		
Fines	\$250 fine for late delivery.		
Invoices + POD to ap@peachtreefreight.com • Carrier signature: _____ • Date: _____			

Your call notes (what was agreed)

Carrier MC	1298456
Equipment	53' dry van
Pickup	Wed 14 Oct, 9–11 CT
Delivery	Thu 15 Oct, 1 PM ET
Commodity	Paper, 38,500 lb
Rate	\$1,750 all-in
Detention	after 2 h, \$50/h
Lumper	paid by broker
Tracking	agreed

Find six errors and one clause to question before Mike signs. Answers at the back of the handbook.

#	Field	What's wrong	What it should say
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
+	Clause to question		



Then write the email

Write a short, polite email to Peachtree asking for a corrected rate con. List every change in one message.

Exercises 2–7

2 • Write a dispatch sheet

Load 1 (Lakeshore Logistics, LL-448210): Chicago, IL shipper, pickup **Wed 10 AM–2 PM CT**, PU# 88120; 42,000 lb, 24 pallets, canned goods; delivery Charlotte, NC **Thu FCFS 8 AM–4 PM ET**, DEL# C-4410; tracking via Trucker Tools; lumper possible. Write Carlos's dispatch sheet.

3 • Check the BOL photo

Carlos sends Load 2's BOL: shipper and consignee correct, **20 pallets**, 38,500 lb, seal 4471023, carrier line **"Southern Star Transport"**. What do you tell Carlos, and what do you do next?

4 • Delivery exception

At Atlanta the receiver writes "1 pallet crushed, refused" on the POD. List your next five actions, in order.

5 • Time zones (U.S. summer time)

U.S. time	PKT
Pickup window 9–11 AM CT	
Delivery Thu 1:00 PM ET	
Carlos stops Wed 9:35 PM CT	
Your shift starts 6 PM PKT: what time in Chicago?	

6 • Broker updates

Write the three broker updates (loaded, on site at receiver, delivered) for Load 1 using realistic times.

7 • Payment math

Load 1 pays \$2,050. What does Blue Line receive with (a) standard terms, (b) 2% quick pay, (c) 3% factoring? Which is fastest?



Bonus

Rename these files using the folder system on page 15: **IMG_4471.jpg** (Load 2 BOL), **scan0003.pdf** (Load 2 POD), **Invoice.pdf** (BL-1024).

Module 9 check

1. Name the eight steps in a load's life and the document each produces.
2. Why must the rate con be signed before dispatch, and who may sign it?
3. Name three rate con clauses that commonly cost carriers money.
4. What belongs on a dispatch sheet? What might be left off, and who decides?
5. What must a bill of lading show under 49 CFR 373.101?
6. What does SLC mean, and when should the driver write it?
7. When should you call the broker instead of sending a message?
8. What makes a POD "clean"? What do you do if freight is damaged?
9. Which documents go with an invoice?
10. If the carrier factors, where does the invoice go, and why?
11. How long must a carrier keep bills of lading under 49 CFR 379?
12. Convert Thursday 1:00 PM Eastern (U.S. summer time) to Pakistan time.

Skills self-check

Skill	Can do	Need practice
Check a rate con line by line and request corrections	☐	☐
Write a complete dispatch sheet with time zones	☐	☐
Plan the load timeline with HOS and PKT times	☐	☐
Check a BOL photo against the rate con	☐	☐
Read a POD and handle exceptions	☐	☐
Build and send an invoice packet the same day	☐	☐
Keep the load tracker, invoice tracker and folders current	☐	☐

Answers

- E1** (1) MC 1298465 → **1298456**. (2) 53' Reefer → **dry van**. (3) Delivery Wed 14 Oct → **Thu 15 Oct**, 1 PM ET. (4) Rate \$1,650 → **\$1,750**. (5) "No detention" → **after 2 h, \$50/h**. (6) Lumper on carrier → **paid by broker**. Question: the **\$250 late fine**: ask to remove it or define "late" (grace period, delays caused by the shipper or receiver).
- E2** Load/broker, tracking, pickup (shipper, address, window 10–2 CT, PU# 88120, 24 plts, 42,000 lb, canned goods), delivery (Charlotte, FCFS 8–4 ET, DEL# C-4410), notes: seal on BOL, BOL photo, lumper receipt, call if delayed. Rate only if Mike allows.
- E3** "Carlos, please don't leave yet." Two problems: 20 vs 22 pallets, and a **different carrier name** (possible double brokering or wrong paperwork). Call Peachtree on its official number; don't move until the count and carrier are corrected in writing (Module 8).
- E4** 1) Driver stays; photos of the pallet, packaging and POD note. 2) Call the broker immediately. 3) Follow written instructions for the refused pallet (return, hold, salvage). 4) Tell Mike. 5) Record everything; send POD with the exception note. Claims: Module 10.
- E5** 7–9 PM PKT · Thu 10:00 PM PKT · Thu 7:35 AM PKT · 8:00 AM Chicago (CT).
- E6** Example: "LL-448210 loaded 12:40 CT, 24 plts, 42,000 lb, seal ____, ETA Thu 9:30 ET." · "LL-448210 on site Charlotte 9:25 ET (FCFS)." · "LL-448210 delivered 11:50 ET clean, POD attached."
- E7** (a) \$2,050 in ~30 days · (b) \$2,009 in ~1–5 days · (c) \$1,988.50 in ~1–2 days. Factoring or quick pay is fastest; standard pays the most.
- Bonus** 03_BOL_pickup.jpg · 04_POD_signed.pdf · 06_Invoice_BL-1024.pdf, inside 2026-10-14_PF-20931_Bolingbrook-Atlanta.
- 1–4** See page 4 (steps) · signed rate con = contract; only people the carrier authorizes sign · tracking deductions, POD deadlines, fines, liability, no TONU · driver info with time zones; rate at carrier's choice.
- 5–8** Consignor/consignee, origin/destination, packages, description, weight/volume · shipper load and count when the driver couldn't see or count · any change to the plan, delay, damage, refusal · counts match, nothing short/damaged, signed; for damage: photos, exact note, call broker.
- 9–12** Invoice, signed rate con, signed BOL/POD, receipts, detention proof · to the factor named in the NOA, so the broker pays the right party · 1 year · 10:00 PM PKT Thursday.

Glossary

BOL — Bill of lading: receipt and contract for the shipment.

Check call — Status update from the driver or to the broker.

Clean POD — Signed delivery with no shortage or damage noted.

Dispatch sheet — The driver's load instructions.

Drop and hook — Swap trailers instead of waiting to load.

Exception — Shortage, overage, damage or refusal noted on the POD.

FCFS — First come, first served: no fixed appointment.

Invoice packet — Invoice + rate con + POD + receipts.

Live load/unload — Driver waits while freight is loaded or unloaded.

OS&D — Over, short and damaged.

POD — Proof of delivery: the signed BOL or delivery receipt.

PU# / DEL# — Pickup or delivery reference numbers.

Quick pay — Broker pays early for a fee.

Rate con — Rate confirmation: the load contract.

Seal — Numbered tag locking the trailer doors.

SLC — Shipper load and count.

TONU — Truck ordered, not used: pay if a load cancels on arrival.

Tracking — Location sharing with the broker (ELD or app).

Sources

Source	What it supports	Where
eCFR	49 CFR 373.101: required information on motor carrier bills of lading	ecfr.gov
eCFR	49 CFR 379 Appendix A: record retention (bills of lading, freight bills, delivery records 1 year)	ecfr.gov
eCFR	49 CFR 371.3: broker records kept 3 years; each party may review	ecfr.gov
J. J. Keller	Shipper's load and count: definition and liability (49 U.S.C. 80113)	jjkellercompliancencetwork.com
Descartes MacroPoint	Carrier FAQs: ELD, TMS and app tracking; tracking sessions	macropoint.com/faqs
Module 4 sources	FMCSA hours-of-service limits used in the timeline	fmcsa.dot.gov
User-supplied	OMNITECH manual: rate con, BOL and signed POD for load #12354; MacroPoint app image; dock photo	your files



Practice material

Peachtree Freight, Load PF-20931, the facilities, invoice BL-1024, check-call messages and payment terms are fictional practice material. Load #12354 documents are real, from your manual.